

Starting a Peer Support Group

Unburied Tools - Peer Support Operations Toolkit

Phase 1: Foundation

- Define your purpose. What need does this group meet?
- Choose a format. In-person, virtual, or hybrid?
- Set a schedule. Weekly? Bi-weekly?
- Identify your co-facilitator.
- Draft group agreements.
- Find a venue or pick a video platform.

Phase 2: Operations

- Create an intake form.
- Set a max group size (6-8).
- Establish a waitlist.
- Draft a confidentiality agreement.
- Set boundaries between sessions.

Phase 3: Launch

- Recruit your first members.
- Do a dry run with co-facilitator.
- Prepare an opening script.
- Prepare a closing ritual.
- Send a pre-session email.

Phase 4: Sustain

- Debrief after each session.
- Track attendance.
- Check in with co-facilitator.
- Review group agreements.
- Evaluate every 6 to 8 sessions.